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Matthias Steiner

Born in Vienna, Austria, Matthias Steiner followed his father's footsteps into weightlifting despite being diagnosed with Type-1 diabetes. In 2004, he sought German citizenship after marrying Susann, a German woman. Tragedy struck a year before the 2008 Beijing Olympics when Susann died in a car accident, causing Steiner to lose around 7-8 kgs due to grief.

Despite this devastating loss, Steiner persevered, receiving German citizenship in early 2008 and intensifying his preparation for the Olympics.

Fast forward to the Games, where the retirement of world record holder Hossein Rezazadeh set the stage for a fierce competition between Steiner, Russian Evgeny Chigishev, and Latvian World Champion Viktors Scerbatihs. Steiner faltered in the snatch round, failing to

lift 207kg on his third attempt and landing fourth in the rankings with 203kg.

In the clean and jerk round, Chigishev and Scerbatihs surged ahead, with first attempts of 240kg and 242kg, respectively. Steiner faced the challenge of lifting 246kg, but despite his efforts, he failed.

However, Scerbatihs' subsequent failure opened a door for Steiner.

With the Russian leading, Steiner needed a 248kg lift to secure a podium spot, which he succeeded.

Fortune seemed to favour him as the Latvian faltered once more. With Chigishev's successful 250kg lift, Steiner knew he had to exceed his previous attempt by 10kg to clinch gold. He summoned all his strength and successfully lifted 258kg, totalling 461kg, 15kg more than his second-best total.

As Steiner stood on the podium, he proudly displayed Susann's photo, symbolising his triumph amidst adversity.